

Activity 8 Instruction Manual

Activity 8 | Topic 01 | C013 | Version v1.0

Purpose

The WBS is the backbone of the plan - everything downstream, schedule and cost, is built from it. GenAI decomposes work quickly; your job is to check the decomposition is complete and mutually exclusive.

Files used

- activity-guide.md and activity-guide.pdf - brief and source instructions
- prompts.pdf - reusable prompt and verification checklist
- mock-data.xlsx - safe fictional project data for practice

Expected output

A three-level WBS and a WBS Dictionary for your work packages.

Before you begin

1. Form the required group and assign one person to capture evidence.
2. Open mock-data.xlsx and review the title, note and column headings.
3. Open prompts.pdf beside your chosen GenAI tool. Do not upload confidential workplace data.

Detailed procedure

1. In your group, prompt GenAI: 'Create a WBS for implementing an internal knowledge portal for a consulting firm.' - or use your own project scenario.
2. Organise the output into levels 1, 2 and 3 in 'WBS Template.pptx'. Level 3 items should be work packages - small enough to assign to one person or team.
3. Apply the 100% rule: the children of any node must add up to all of that node's work, with no overlap. Ask GenAI: 'Does this WBS satisfy the 100% rule? Identify any missing or overlapping work.'
4. Check for the work GenAI habitually forgets: project management effort itself, testing, training, documentation, handover and warranty support. Add what is missing.
5. Open 'WBS Dictionary.xlsx'. Prompt GenAI: 'For each work package, produce a WBS dictionary entry with WBS code, description of work, responsible role, resources required, cost estimate, quality requirements and acceptance criteria.'
6. Review each entry - particularly the acceptance criteria, which must be testable. Rewrite any that are vague ('works well' is not an acceptance criterion).
7. Confirm the flow is intact: Scope Statement → WBS → Work Packages → Activity List, ready for scheduling. Share with the class.

Use the supplied mock data

Copy only the rows needed for the current step and tell the model the data is fictional. If the model changes an identifier or number, reject the change and rerun with an explicit preserve-values instruction.

Quality control

- Your WBS decomposes to assignable work packages, satisfies the 100% rule, includes PM/testing/training effort, and every dictionary entry has testable acceptance criteria.
- Compare the first AI draft with the final human-corrected artifact and retain both as evidence.
- Label assumptions, decisions, owners and dates so another project manager can audit the result.

Troubleshooting

If the response is generic, add the project objective, constraints, audience and required columns. If arithmetic is inconsistent, request formulas and substitutions, then calculate independently. If a source cannot be opened, remove the claim or replace it with verified evidence.

Submission evidence

Submit the completed project artifact, the final prompt, a short critique of the AI output, and any screenshot or exported file required by the activity.